

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX-----X
Jeanette Gengaro,

Plaintiffs

-against-

City of New York, New York City Police Department,
Police Officer Matthew Degrote, Shield 10362 of
NARCBBX, Detective Brian Query, Shield 5001 of
NARCBBX, Undercover Police Officer John Doe and New
York City Police Officers John Doe,Defendants
-----XIndex Number:
Date Purchased:
Date Filed:

SUMMONS

Plaintiff's residence is:
975 East 181 Street
Bronx, NY 10460

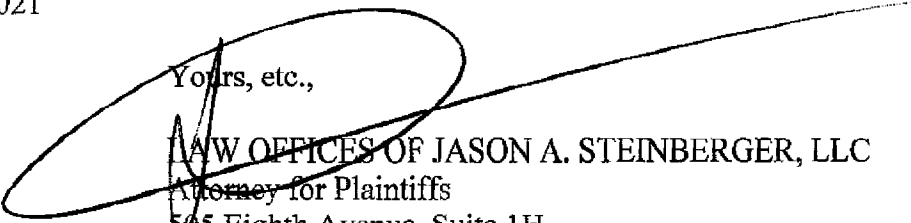
TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to Answer the Verified Complaint in this action and serve a copy of your answer, or if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons to serve a notice of Appearance on the Plaintiffs attorney within twenty (20) days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within thirty (30) days after the service is complete if this Summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York) and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the Verified Complaint.

The basis of venue designated is that the cause of action arose in Bronx County.

Dated: January 28, 2021
Bronx, NY

Yours, etc.,


LAW OFFICES OF JASON A. STEINBERGER, LLC
Attorney for Plaintiffs
505 Eighth Avenue, Suite 1H
New York, NY 10018
(646) 256-1007

To: City of New York

New York City Police Department

Police Officer Matthew Degrote, Shield 10362 of NARCB BX

Detective Brian Query, Shield 5001 of NARB BX

Undercover Police Officer John Doe

New York City Police Officers John Doe

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X	:	
Jeanette Gengaro,	:	
	:	
Plaintiffs	:	VERIFIED COMPLAINT
	:	
-against-	:	
	:	
City of New York, New York City Police Department,	:	
Police Officer Matthew Degrote, Shield 10362 of	:	
NARCBX, Detective Brian Query, Shield 5001 of	:	
NARCBX, Undercover Police Officer John Doe and New	:	
York City Police Officers John Doe,	:	
	:	
Defendants	:	
-----X	:	

Plaintiff, by and through his attorney, JASON A. STEINBERGER, Esq, for his complaint,
alleges upon information and belief as follows:

STATEMENT OF FACTS

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Plaintiff Jeanette Gengaro, (hereinafter referred to as "GENGARO") resides in Bronx County, State of New York.
2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Police Officer Matthew Degrote, Shield 10362 of NARCBX, (hereinafter referred to as "DEGROTE") was employed by the New York City Police Department.
3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Detective Brian Query, Shield 5001 of NARCBX, (hereinafter referred to as "QUERY") was employed by the New York City Police Department.

4. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the Undercover Police Officer John Doe, the officer involved in the arrest of Plaintiff (hereinafter referred to as "UC DOE") was employed by the New York City Police Department.

5. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the New York City Police Officers John Doe, involved in the arrest of Plaintiff (hereinafter referred to as "DOES") were employed by the New York City Police Department.

6. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant City of New York, is a municipal corporation organized and existing under the laws of the State of New York, with a principal place of business located at 1 Centre Street, County of New York State of New York.

7. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant New York City Police Department, is an agency created and maintained by the above municipal government.

8. On or about July 14, 2020 notice required by Municipal Law 50-E was given to City of New York, by personal service. Said notice set forth the facts underlying Plaintiffs' claim against the City of New York, and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been paid by the City of New York.

9. That on or about October 20, 2020 a hearing required by Municipal Law 50-H was held. At said hearing Plaintiff testified and set forth the facts underlying Plaintiff's claim against the City of New York and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York in response to this claim.

10. That on or about February 21, 2020 at approximately 10:30 AM in the vicinity of 975 East 181 Street, Apartment 6A, Bronx, NY Plaintiff was home when she DEGROTE, QUERY on DOES unlawfully entered Plaintiff's apartment, handcuffed her and arrested her.

11. That at no time prior, had Plaintiff been involved in any criminal or unlawful activity.
12. That at no time did Plaintiff possess narcotics or marijuana in her home.
13. That at no time had Plaintiff sold narcotics to UC DOE.
14. That all times QUERY knew that UC DOE did not purchase narcotics from UC DOE.
15. That after Plaintiff was arrested she was transported to the 48 precinct.
16. That after Plaintiff arrived at the 48 precinct she was placed into a cell with other female prisoners.
17. That after Plaintiff arrived at the 48 precinct she was strip searched and nothing illegal or unlawful was recovered.
18. That after being held for several hours at the 48 precinct, Plaintiff was transported to Bronx County Central Booking located at 215 East 161 Street, Bronx, NY 10451.
19. That on or about February 22, 2020 Plaintiff was arraigned in Bronx County Criminal Court on docket CR-003997-20BX charging her with Criminal Possession of a Controlled Substance in the Seventh Degree and Unlawful Possession of Marijuana.
20. That at the time of her arraignment, Plaintiff's case was dismissed upon application of the Office of the Bronx County District Attorney.

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

21. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 20, as if more fully stated herein at length.
22. That Defendants acted with actual malice toward Plaintiff and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of the Plaintiff.

23. That the actions of the Defendants constituted unreasonable deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

24. That as a result of the allegations made by the Defendants and the arrest, Plaintiff's child was removed from her custody for over six (6) months.

25. That as a result of the actions by Defendants Plaintiff was traumatized and fears for her physical and emotional safety when she sees and encounters members of the New York City Police Department from that day and onward.

26. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff has been unable to sleep.

27. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff was forced to miss multiple days from work.

28. That as a result of the Defendants' actions Plaintiff sustained damage to his person in the sum within the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

29. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 28, as if more fully stated herein at length.

30. The intentional verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and maliciously prosecuted by Defendants violated the rights of Plaintiff as guaranteed by the Fourth, Fifth and Eighth Amendments to the United States Constitution, as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable.

31. Defendants having no lawful authority to arrest Plaintiff did, nevertheless, unlawfully arrest Plaintiff with actual malice toward her and with willful and wanton indifference to and

deliberate disregard for his constitutional rights. Thus Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

32. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 31, as if more fully stated herein at length.

33. Defendants conspired to violate Plaintiff's statutory civil rights in violation of 42 U.S.C. sec.1983, et al as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable. Thus Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages, as well as attorney's fees.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

34. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 33, as if more fully stated herein at length.

35. Plaintiff was verbally abused, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned and maliciously prosecuted by Defendants in a manner that was extreme, outrageous and unjustified and caused Plaintiff to suffer physical and severe emotional distress for which the Defendants are individually liable. The verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution on and of Plaintiff by Defendants were unjustified and done with actual malice and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

36. That as a result of the case, Defendants maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by continuing to cooperate in a family court prosecution in an effort to remove her child from her when they knew

she had not endangered the welfare of her child. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

37. That during the pendency of the case, Defendants maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by claiming that Plaintiff sold narcotics when they knew she had not. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST CITY OF NEW YORK AND
NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

38. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 37, as if more fully stated herein at length.

39. At all times pertinent hereto, DEGROTE, QUERY, UC DOE and DOES were acting within the scope of their employment as officers of the New York City Police Department and City of New York.

40. The City of New York and New York City Police Department are each liable for compensatory damages under the doctrine of respondeat superior for the intentional torts that DEGROTE, QUERY, UC DOE and DOES committed within the scope of their employment. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory exemplary damages.

AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

41. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 40, as if more fully stated herein at length.

42. The City of New York and New York City Police Department's failure to provide adequate training and supervision to DEGROTE, QUERY, UC DOE and DOES constitutes a

cursory, with respect to narcotics arrests that it was ineffective and permitted and tolerated the unreasonable detention of Plaintiff

50. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory with respect to narcotics arrests that it was ineffective and permitted the wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of Plaintiff.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against the Defendants as follows:

On the first cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts;

On the second cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts, together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

On the third cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

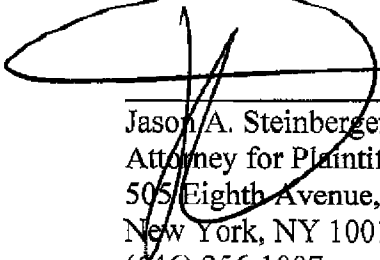
On the fourth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the Defendants' wanton and willful actions;

On the fifth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts

On the sixth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts.

On the seventh cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

Law Offices of Jason A. Steinberger, LLC

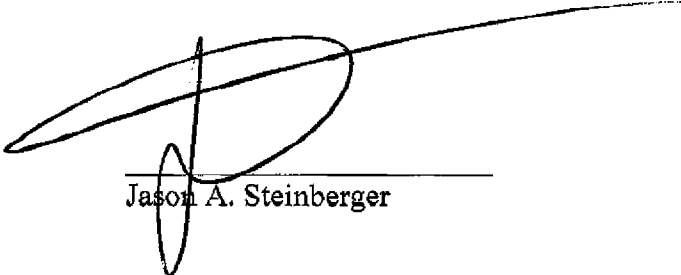


Jason A. Steinberger, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff
505 Eighth Avenue, Suite 1H
New York, NY 10018
(646) 256-1007

STATE OF NEW YORK: COUNTY OF NEW YORK

The undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the State of New York, under penalties of perjury, affirms the following to be true: Affirmant has read the foregoing Complaint and the contents thereof; the same is true to affirmant's own knowledge, except as to matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief and as to those matters affirmant believes it to be true; and the reason this verification is made by affirmant and not by the plaintiff is because the plaintiff is not within the county in which your affirmant maintains his principal office. The grounds of affirmant's belief as to all matters not stated upon affirmant's knowledge are communications with the plaintiff, review of records and documents within affirmant's possession.

Affirmed: January 28, 2021



Jason A. Steinberger